

Final Test — C1 Exit Check

The end-of-course check on all eight modules, taken on the last day, which is also a celebration. It shows each learner what they can now do in English: follow a lecture and capture its structure in notes, read an argument critically and name its weaknesses, write a structured essay or report in a controlled academic or professional register, use the precision grammar and vocabulary of C1, and hold their own in an individual interview with a long turn, push-back, and a diplomatic task. It also gives you the evidence for the next step: Mastery English (C2), C2 with a review plan, another round of C1 with more support, or a specialist track (IELTS Academic or Business English). It is never a pass/fail verdict on a person.



~60 min written

+ ~10 min interview each

Written /85 • Speaking /15 • Total /100

Covers Modules 1-8

FRAME IT AS "SHOW WHAT YOU CAN DO"

By Class 26 your learners have met you 25 times, and yesterday they presented and defended a position paper. Use that: **"Thirteen weeks ago we were placing events in the future with the future perfect. Yesterday you wrote a position paper, conceded a fair point under questioning, and still held your ground, all in English."** Do every example item together, keep the room calm and unhurried, and plan the celebration so it happens *whatever* the scores are. Every learner gets a certificate of attendance. The test decides the **next class**, not who gets to celebrate.

RUNNING CLASS 26 (90 MIN)

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Welcome & set-up	5 min	T-S	Greet everyone. Remind them: skim the questions first, and in Part 1 write keywords , not sentences. Papers go out face down, and learners write their names.
Part 1 • Listening	15 min	T-S	Whole class. Give 60 seconds to read the notes frame in Part A and 30 seconds for each later section, then read each script on the teacher pages twice .

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Parts 2–4 · written	45 min	S	Individual work. Suggest a pace on the board: Part 2 Reading about 12 minutes, Part 3 Use of English about 10, Part 4 Writing about 23. Interviews run at the same time at a side table (or in the hallway). Call learners one by one for about 10 minutes each, which is 4 learners. Start with learners who finish Part 3 quickly, and let them finish their writing afterwards. If a volunteer or co-teacher is free, they supervise the room. If not, sit where you can see everyone.
Break	5 min	—	Collect papers. Set out snacks if your program allows.
Remaining interviews + celebration	20 min	S–S · T–S	Finish one more interview while the class makes a " Now I can... " wall : each learner writes three things they can do now on sticky notes ("I can concede a fair point and still defend my case."). Then certificates, a one-sentence goal from each learner in the future perfect ("By this time next year, I'll have..."), a class photo if everyone agrees, and how to join Mastery English (C2) or a specialist track. With more than 5 learners , book 10-minute one-to-one slots in the week before or after (Class 25 is too busy for interviews: you are chairing the position-paper defenses). Never shorten an interview below 9 minutes to fit everyone in; move it instead.

◆ YOU NEED

- ◆ One learner paper each (the middle section of this pack)
- ◆ Teacher pages: listening scripts, the **interview script**, the long-turn cards, the discussion statements and the diplomatic-task cards (cut), and one interview grid per learner
- ◆ The key and rubrics: [assessment/assessment-key.html](#)
- ◆ Certificates, sticky notes, and a timer

◆ WHAT EACH PART CHECKS

- ◆ **Listening /15**: a mini-lecture with structured note-taking; the functions of turns in a seminar; what stress and intonation mean
- ◆ **Reading /15**: critical reading of an opinion column (claim, fact vs opinion, argument weaknesses, loaded language, the writer's moves and tone)
- ◆ **Use of English /25**: grammar across Modules 1–5, dependent prepositions and fixed phrases, formal vocabulary, and editing for concision
- ◆ **Writing /30**: a structured essay *or* a report (about 250 words), scored with the writing rubric
- ◆ **Speaking /15**: an individual interview of about 10 minutes with a long turn, a discussion with push-back, and a diplomatic register task

LITERACY-ADAPTED VERSION

Same paper, different delivery. **Read all instructions and items aloud**, enlarge the paper, and give extra time or split it over two sittings. Part 1: the learner may **say** the missing keywords while you write them. Parts 2–3: read the column and the choices aloud and accept a spoken answer (for the one-word items, the learner says the word and you check the form). Part 4: the learner **dictates** the essay or report while you scribe, and you score it with the same rubric. Mark the paper "**Adapted**". For these learners, the **interview and listening** are the main evidence for placement. The key explains how to recommend C2 together with literacy support instead of holding someone back for reading and writing alone.

REAL OR IMAGINED, YOUR SIDE OR AN ASSIGNED SIDE

The interview asks about change, decisions, and opinions. For some learners, questions about work and the past touch on a lost profession, a hard journey, or a qualification that isn't recognized here yet. Say before you start: **"Real or imagined, no problem. And in the discussion, I'll argue against you on purpose. That's my job today, not my real opinion. You can take any side you like."** Never ask follow-up questions about home country, family members who are absent, or immigration status. If a learner says "I'd rather not talk about that," thank them and move to the next stage.

Look How Far I've Come

Name: _____

Date: _____

Class: _____



Listen



Take notes



Read



Circle



Write



Speak

Skim the questions **before** you listen or read, and look at each example first. If an instruction isn't clear, just ask.



Part 1 · Listening

___ / 15



A. Listen to a short lecture on urban heat. Complete the notes with one word or a number in each gap. You will hear the lecture twice.



TALK: urban heat = mostly a matter of (1) _____, not just weather

3 points announced

Pt 1 · cause: dark surfaces absorb heat → release it slowly at (2)

_____ - city center up to (3) _____ °C warmer than farmland

★ difference greatest at night

Pt 2 · who pays: neighborhoods w/ few (4) _____ = hotter

- often can't afford to run (5) _____ conditioning

- e.g. heat illness ↑ among (6) _____ residents living alone

Pt 3 · solutions: trees, lighter roofs, green space

- street trees → sidewalk temp ↓ by up to (7) _____ degrees

RECAP: urban heat = design problem ∴ solvable

8 Which point does the speaker say she cares about most?

the causes

who pays the price

what can be done

9 When she says, "As an aside, I won't dwell on the history of air conditioning," she is ...

a) introducing her main argument

b) signaling a digression that listeners can safely skip

c) giving an example to support her second point

 **B. Listen to part of a seminar. What is each numbered speaker doing? Write the letter.**



There is 1 extra letter.

a coming in politely

b building on someone's point

c paraphrasing to check understanding

d steering the group toward a decision

e disagreeing constructively

10 ☐ Elena

11 ☐ Mia

12 ☐ Kofi

13 ☐ Elena (again)

  **C. Listen to how each sentence is said. Circle what the speaker means.**

14 *"It's a good idea..."*

a) She agrees completely.

b) She likes it in principle but has some doubts.

15 *"I didn't say she took it."*

a) I said that somebody took it, but not her.

b) Somebody else said it, not me.



Read this opinion column from a college newspaper. Read it once for sense, then again critically.

Close the Laptops: Why Our Lecture Halls Need a Screen Ban

¶1 Walk into any lecture hall on campus and you will see the same depressing spectacle: rows of students hunched over glowing screens, scrolling, shopping, and chatting while a professor talks to the backs of their laptops. Every sensible educator knows that this so-called "digital learning" is nothing of the kind. It is time our college banned laptops from lectures altogether.

¶2 The evidence is hard to ignore. Since Westbrook College began allowing laptops in lectures in 2015, average exam scores in first-year courses have fallen by six percent. Researchers have published dozens of studies on laptops in the classroom, with mixed results, but one widely shared study found that students who took notes by hand remembered more of a lecture than those who typed. And three professors in my own department tell me that their students have never been more distracted.

¶3 Of course, some students genuinely need a laptop, for example those with a disability that makes handwriting difficult. I accept that, and any ban should include exemptions for them. But these cases are rare, and they should not be used as an excuse to keep a failed experiment running.

¶4 Supporters of laptops will say that students are adults who should be free to choose how they learn. It is a charming idea. But students today simply cannot resist the temptation of a screen; they have grown up with phones in their hands and have the attention span to prove it.

¶5 The choice before the college is simple. Either we ban laptops now, or we accept that lectures will become little more than background noise for online shopping. I know which future I would choose.

1 In one sentence, what is the writer's **central claim**?

 Is each statement from the column a fact (it could be checked) or an opinion?

2	"Westbrook College began allowing laptops in lectures in 2015."	Fact	Opinion
3	"This so-called 'digital learning' is nothing of the kind."	Fact	Opinion
4	"Average exam scores in first-year courses have fallen by six percent."	Fact	Opinion
5	"Students today simply cannot resist the temptation of a screen."	Fact	Opinion



Name the weakness in each part of the argument. Use a term from the box. There is 1 extra term.

false cause false dilemma cherry-picking unsupported generalization
appeal to emotion

- 6 ¶2 "Since Westbrook College began allowing laptops... exam scores... have fallen by six percent."
-
- 7 ¶5 "Either we ban laptops now, or we accept that lectures will become... background noise."
-
- 8 ¶4 "They have grown up with phones in their hands and have the attention span to prove it."
-
- 9 ¶2 "...dozens of studies... with mixed results, but one widely shared study found..."
-
- 10 Copy **two** different examples of loaded or emotive language from ¶1.
-
- 11 In ¶3, when the writer says "I accept that", she ...
- concedes a point refutes a point exaggerates a point

12 In ¶13, with "these cases are rare", the writer ...

gives new evidence

downplays the exceptions

changes her position

13 In ¶14, the writer calls the idea "a charming idea." What is she really implying?

14 The writer's tone is best described as ...

measured and neutral

indignant and one-sided

hesitant and uncertain



A. Circle the correct word or words.

- 0 e.g. The committee recommends that the deadline **be** ☐ is extended.
- 1 By the time the inspectors arrive, we ☐ will have fixed ☐ will be fixing ☐ fix every fault.
- 2 There's the doorbell. That ☐ will ☐ would ☐ shall be the courier.
- 3 If she ☐ isn't ☐ weren't ☐ wouldn't be so cautious by nature, she would have invested years ago.
- 4 ☐ Had ☐ Should ☐ Were you require any assistance, please contact reception.
- 5 Not until the results came in ☐ we realized ☐ did we realize ☐ we did realize our mistake.
- 6 *(formal writing)* The reason the project failed is ☐ because ☐ that ☐ why nobody took ownership of it.
- 7 ☐ Having finished ☐ Finished ☐ Having been finished the report, she emailed it to the board.
- 8 Which sentence is correct?
- ☐ a) Walking into the room, the noise was overwhelming.
- ☐ b) Walking into the room, I found the noise overwhelming.
- ☐ c) Walked into the room, the noise was overwhelming.
- 9 The funds ☐ having run out ☐ having ran out ☐ had run out, the project was suspended.
- 10 Applicants must register by Friday; those who fail to ☐ do so ☐ make so ☐ do it so will lose their place.



B. Write one word in each gap.

- 11 All suppliers must comply _____ the new safety standards.
- 12 The findings are consistent _____ earlier research.

13 There has been a sharp increase _____ demand for evening classes.

14 _____ behalf of the whole team, I'd like to thank you.

15 In the _____ of a fire, please use the stairs.



C. Replace the informal words in brackets with one formal word that suits an academic report.

0 e.g. We did not have **sufficient** evidence to draw a conclusion. (*enough*)

16 The researchers _____ samples from twelve schools. (*got*)

17 The data clearly _____ a rise in absences. (*show*)

18 Conditions began to _____ after the storm. (*get worse*)

19 The committee will _____ the complaint. (*look into*)

20 The trial will _____ in March. (*start*)



D. Edit for concision. Write a shorter version of each phrase. (one word each)

21 due to the fact that → _____

22 at this point in time → _____

23 make a decision → _____

24 has the ability to → _____

25 very important → _____ (*one strong adjective*)



Part 4 · Writing

___ / 30



Choose one task. Write about 250 words (230–280). Plan for 3–4 minutes first, and leave 3 minutes at the end to edit.

◆ □ OPTION A · AN ARGUMENT ESSAY

"Some employers now use software that records how much time staff spend typing, reading email, and visiting websites. To what extent is this kind of monitoring justified?"

Write **four or five paragraphs**: an introduction (hook → context → thesis), body paragraphs that each develop **one point** with evidence or an example, a paragraph that **acknowledges a counter-argument and rebuts it**, and a conclusion that restates, synthesizes, and points to an implication, with **no new points**. You may argue either side. It doesn't have to be your personal view.

◆ □ OPTION B · A REPORT

You volunteer at the **Riverside Adult Learning Center**. The director has asked you to report on why attendance at evening classes has fallen and to recommend what to do. Use the survey results below. Write a report with **headings** (Introduction · Findings · Conclusions · Recommendations), an **objective** tone, and clear, actionable recommendations.

Survey of 120 learners (October)	
Average attendance: last year → this year	85% → 64%
Say 6–8 p.m. classes clash with their work shifts	58%
Would attend a Saturday-morning option	41%
Report problems finding parking	35%
Rate the teaching "good" or "excellent"	72%

This essay will argue that ... / This report sets out to ...

The evidence suggests that ...

It was found that ...

Admittedly, ... Nevertheless, ...

This overlooks the fact that ...

Not only ... but also ...

In light of these findings, ...

It is recommended that ... be ...

On balance, the weight of evidence ...

Continue on the back if you need more space. Word count (approximately): _____

FOR THE TEACHER	1 LISTENING	2 READING	3 USE OF ENGLISH	4 WRITING	WRITTEN	SPEAKING	TOTAL
Score	/15	/15	/25	/30	/85	/15	/100

PART 1 • LISTENING SCRIPTS

Give 60 seconds to read the notes frame in Part A and 30 seconds for each later section. Read each script **twice** at a natural pace, and pause about 10 seconds between readings. Read Part A as a real lecture: slow down very slightly and **stress each signpost** (*first... that brings me to... as an aside... finally... to recap... the upshot is...*), exactly as Lesson 7.1 taught learners to expect. Don't pause at the gaps or repeat the numbers. For Part B, change your voice or position for each speaker, or read it with colleagues, and say the item number before each numbered speaker ("Ten.") so learners can keep their place. In Part C, say the number, then the sentence **once per reading**, with the marked intonation. Don't read the answer choices aloud.

◆ A • MINI-LECTURE: "URBAN HEAT" (READ THE WHOLE LECTURE TWICE, THEN GIVE 1 MINUTE)

READ ALOUD

Good afternoon. Today I'd like to talk about something you've almost certainly felt, even if you've never had a name for it: the urban heat island. I'll argue that heat in cities is not just a matter of weather; it's largely a matter of **design**. I'll make three points: first, why cities get hotter than the countryside around them; second, who pays the price; and third, **the one I care about most, what can realistically be done**.

So, first, the cause. Dark surfaces (asphalt, roofs, parking lots) absorb the sun's heat during the day and release it slowly at **night**. On a summer evening, a city center can be up to **seven** degrees Celsius warmer than nearby farmland. Crucially, the difference is often greatest at night, which is exactly when our bodies need to cool down.

That brings me to my second point: who pays the price. **As an aside, I won't dwell on the history of air conditioning**, fascinating as it is. The key thing is that heat is not shared equally. Neighborhoods with few **trees** are, on average, noticeably hotter than leafy ones, and they are often the areas where people can least afford to run **air** conditioning. A case in point is heat-related illness among **older** residents living alone, which rises sharply during long hot spells.

Finally, and most importantly, what can we do? The answers are not new: plant trees, paint roofs a lighter color, and replace some paved areas with green space. Street trees, in particular, can lower the temperature of the sidewalk beneath them by as much as **twenty** degrees. None of this is expensive compared with the cost of doing nothing.

So, to recap: cities trap heat because of the materials we build with; the burden falls hardest on those with the fewest resources; and the solutions are already within reach. The upshot is that urban heat is a design problem, which means it is also a problem we can design our way out of.

◆ B • SEMINAR: "SHOULD FIRST-YEAR STUDENTS HAVE TO TAKE A STUDY-SKILLS COURSE?" (READ TWICE, THEN GIVE 1 MINUTE)

Kofi: I think a required study-skills course would help a lot of first-year students. What are your thoughts, Elena?

(10) Elena: Building on what you said, I'd add that many students have never been taught how to take notes in a lecture.

(11) Mia: I take your point, but I'm not sure making it compulsory is the answer. Some students already have these skills, and they'd resent it.

(12) Kofi: So if I understand you correctly, you'd make it optional for students who can show they don't need it?

Mia: Exactly.

(13) Elena: So where does that leave us? Maybe a short skills check in the first week, and the course for anyone who needs it? Shall we move on to who would teach it?

◆ C • WHAT DOES THE SPEAKER MEAN?

READ ALOUD

Number 14: **It's a good idea...** (Say it with a clear **fall-rise** on *idea*: ↘ ↗, and let your voice trail off, as if a "but" is coming.)

Number 15: **I didn't say SHE took it.** (Put strong **contrastive stress** on *she*; keep every other word light.)

INDIVIDUAL SPEAKING INTERVIEW • ABOUT 10 MINUTES

Sit **beside** the learner, not across a desk, with the grid on your lap. Speak at a natural pace, with natural contractions. Ask the **core** question first. If there's no answer after about 5 seconds, use the **support** version (rephrase, narrow the question, or give a model). If the answer comes easily, add the **stretch** question. At C1, listen for **precision and control**: a long turn that is organized and signposted, claims calibrated to the evidence, an argument that bends without breaking under push-back, and a register that shifts on purpose. Don't correct during the interview. Note one strength and one next step instead. **Before stage 1**, let the learner choose a long-turn card and think about it quietly (about 1 minute) while you do the warm-up.

1

Warm-up: work, study & what's next

~1 min

SAY: *Hello! How are you today? So, tell me a little about what you've been working on or studying this term. (real or imagined)*

SAY: *And what do you think you'll be doing this time next year?*

Support: "Is that at work, in your studies, or somewhere else?" · **Stretch:** "What will you have achieved by then, do you think, and how sure are you?" (future perfect + the certainty dial)

2

Long turn (monologue)

~3 min

SAY: *Now please talk about the card you chose, for about two minutes. I'll just listen.*

Don't interrupt. Time about 2 minutes; stop kindly at 2½. Then ask **one** follow-up question about the content.

Support: if they freeze, ask "What's your main point?" then "Can you give me an example?" · **Stretch:** "What's the strongest objection someone could raise to that?" or "How confident are you in that, and why?" Listen for a **preview and a recap**, signposting, calibrated certainty (*may well, it would appear that*), and at least one structure used for effect (an inversion, a cleft, a mixed conditional).

Read **one** discussion statement below. Whatever the learner says, take the **other side** and push back **twice**, politely but firmly, so they must defend, concede, or refine their view. The second push-back should target their **evidence** ("How do you know that?") or expose a hidden assumption. Your push-back is a role, not your opinion.

SAY: *Here's a statement: [statement]. Where do you stand on that? ... Why? ... I'm not sure I agree. Surely [counter-argument]? ... But how do you know that [their claim] is actually true? ... So, on balance, where does that leave you?*

Support: "Do you agree or disagree?" then "Why?" and one push-back only · **Stretch:** "What would it take to change your mind?" · "Can you put the other side's case as fairly as you can?" Listen for **acknowledge** → **soften** → **challenge** (*I take your point, but...*), hedging that matches the evidence, a **concession that doesn't collapse** the argument, and a refined final position.

4

Diplomatic task + register shift

~2½ min

The learner chooses **one** task card. Part 1: you play the other person (client, manager, or colleague) and react naturally, including one mild objection. Part 2: switch. You are now the learner's friend, and they tell you what happened, informally.

SAY: (Client) *I'm calling about our order. Is everything on schedule? ... Two weeks? That's a real problem for us. ... What can you offer?*

SAY: (Manager) *I've decided to move our team meeting to 7:30 on Monday mornings. It'll get things started early. What do you think? ... But everyone's fresh at that time, surely?*

SAY: (Colleague) *Could you take over the Henderson project next week? I'm completely swamped. ... Are you sure? It would really help me out.*

SAY: (Switch) *OK, now I'm your friend. Hey! So how did that go? What did they say?*

Listen for **preface** → **soften** → **reason** (*I'm afraid... · the thing is... · because...*), distancing (*I was wondering whether... · Would it be possible to...?*), an alternative offered, and a message that stays **clear** under the cushioning. In Part 2, listen for the whole register shifting together: contractions, phrasal verbs, vague language, reported speech. **Support:** model the first line ("I'm afraid I have some difficult news..."). **Stretch:** push back a second time and see whether they hold a polite line.

5

Closing + your question

~½ min

SAY: *Thank you, that's everything. Before you go, is there anything you'd like to ask me? About the course, what comes next, anything at all.*

LONG TURN • LOOK AHEAD

 Ten years from now

Choose a change you can see coming in your field, your workplace, or your community. Where will things be in ten years? What will have changed, and what will people be doing differently? How certain are you, and why?

LONG TURN • EXPLAIN IT

 A short talk for non-experts

Explain a process or skill you know well (a recipe, a repair, a work procedure, a sport) as if giving a short talk. Preview your points, take the listener through them, and finish with a recap.

LONG TURN • WHAT IF...?

 A turning point

A decision, a chance meeting, or a piece of luck (real or imagined). Explain what happened, then trace the what-ifs: how would things be different now if it had gone another way? Was one factor decisive?

LONG TURN • WEIGH IT UP

 Is it really true?

Choose a claim you often hear: "Multitasking makes us more productive." • "Everyone should learn to code." • "Breakfast is the most important meal of the day." What evidence supports it? What are its weaknesses? What's your verdict?

◆ DISCUSSION STATEMENTS (YOU CHOOSE ONE • TAKE THE OTHER SIDE)

- ◆ "Employers should be allowed to monitor everything staff do on work computers."
- ◆ "Colleges should record every lecture and put it online."
- ◆ "Cities should turn more parking spaces into bike lanes and outdoor seating."
- ◆ "A four-day workweek would benefit almost everyone."

If the learner chose Writing Option A, avoid the first statement so that the interview gives you fresh evidence.

◆ DIPLOMATIC TASK CARDS (CUT • THE LEARNER CHOOSES ONE)

DIPLOMACY • FORMAL → INFORMAL

 Bad news for a client

You coordinate orders for a small company. A client's order will be **two weeks late** because a supplier let you down. Tell the client, keep the relationship warm, and offer an alternative (a partial delivery, a discount...). Then tell a friend how the call went.

DIPLOMACY • FORMAL → INFORMAL

 Disagree with your manager

Your manager wants to move the weekly team meeting to **7:30 a.m. on Mondays**. You think it's a bad idea for several people on the team. Disagree diplomatically and propose another option. Then tell a friend what happened.

**Say no to a colleague**

A colleague asks you to take over a large project next week, but you can't: you already have a deadline. Decline politely, give a reason, and suggest another way you could help. Then tell a friend about it.

INTERVIEW SCORING GRID

Score each criterion 0–3: 0 = no response • 1 = Not yet C1 • 2 = C1 • 3 = C1+ (strong). Descriptors are in the assessment key. Total /15. Print one per learner.

Learner: _____ Date: _____ Long turn: _____ Task: ☐ Client ☐ Manager
☐ Colleague ☐ Adapted

CRITERION	WHAT TO LISTEN FOR	SCORE (0–3)
Task & coherence	A long turn with a preview, clearly developed points, and a recap; a reasoned position that survives push-back or is refined honestly; a diplomatic message that stays clear; both parts of the task completed	
Range & register	Precise, varied language used for effect (future perfect, the certainty dial, mixed conditionals, inversion or cleft, nominal phrases, strong collocations); hedging and distancing where they fit; a full register shift in stage 4	
Accuracy	Consistent control of complex structures: aspect, modal perfects, conditional time logic, dependent prepositions, participle clauses. Errors are rare, hard to spot, and often self-corrected	
Interaction	Acknowledges before challenging; concedes without collapsing; asks for clarification or paraphrases when needed; negotiates an alternative in the task; asks you a real question at the end	
Pronunciation & fluency	Speaks fluently with only a conceptually difficult topic slowing them; buys time with phrases rather than silence; stress on new or contrasted information; fall-rise for reservation; intonation polite in the formal role and relaxed in the informal one	
Total /15 • Went well: _____ • Next step: _____		

AFTER THE TEST

Score with the key and put written + speaking on the placement summary. Score the writing with the rubric (/15) and **double it** for the paper total (/30). Tell each learner their next step **privately** and kindly before they leave, or at a short one-to-one in the following week. Never read scores aloud. The key's "grade to outcome" table shows who is ready for **Mastery English (C2)**, who goes on with a review plan, who should repeat C1 with support, and who might be better served by the **IELTS Academic** or **Business English** tracks.